

CARE OF INDOOR VINES

Ensure your vines receive enough water, especially while the fruits are developing, but do not allow them to become waterlogged. Feed the vines with a high-nitrogen fertilizer, and mulch around them with well-rotted manure or garden compost in late winter. Do not allow the mulch to touch the vine stems.

Ensure that vines are kept well-ventilated by opening greenhouse vents over winter to allow air to circulate. It is important not to allow the air to become stagnant, since diseases will thrive in these conditions. Do not allow the temperature to drop below 41°F (5°C).

In winter, scrape away any old bark, where pests such as red



Thin bunches to encourage larger fruits.

spider mite and mealy bug may be hiding. Remove bugs by hand and use insecticide, if necessary. Plants will become heavy over time and will need careful pruning and training (see tip box below). Dessert grapes will need to be thinned to encourage larger fruits—using scissors, reduce each bunch by about a third.

TIP PRUNING AND TRAINING

All grape vines will require annual pruning in winter while the plant is dormant. Vines can be trained into cordons, which are the most common greenhouse form, with the fruiting stems branching from a vertical main stem. For guyot shapes, the fruiting stems branch upward from the main horizontal branches. Ensure that you provide your plant with adequate supports, and tie in stems securely.



Remove the weakest side-shoots, leaving the strongest two to be trained on wires.